Interviewer

Hi. So, I'm researching how students actually go about forming teams for class projects, and I want you to tell me about your experience when you are forming a group or team for assignments.

So, the first question is: think about your experience forming a team on a class project and what went well and what did not.

Speaker

So, it's usually depending on the class that I'm taking. So sometimes there is someone that I know in that class, right? And sometimes I don't know anybody in that class as well.

So, if I am trying to form a team for my project assignment, I will just ask them if they actually need someone to form a new team, right?

What went well is that sometimes there are some people who understand, who are just like, "Okay, you can come with us," or just say that, "It's okay, we can ask the tutor if we can add another member or not."

But there are also times when I have to ask someone, and then this person would actually just say no in a—not in a bad way. Like, yeah, they would be saying whether they need someone else or something like that. So yeah, it's the kind of experience that I've experienced before.

Interviewer

How do you approach them?

Speaker

Basically, I would just find someone who I think would need one, because in a class situation, sometimes we can see whether that team is already complete or not. So I would come to a team that is not yet completed. And then I ask the team member about that.

Interviewer

Do you ever have an experience where you just approach people and then you think about it twice and then try to approach another?

Speaker

Yeah. So far, no, I don't think so.

Interviewer

Okay. So it's usually the first one you approach. It's the first one to become your...?

Speaker

Yeah, but I do have an experience where the tutor told me that we can form a team within these two weeks. So on the first week, I asked this team, and then this team said that, "Yeah, we can think about it later."

And then by the next week, I asked—I saw them already completed, already made a team, so I had to move to another team for that.

Interviewer

Okay. Who are the people you usually approach? Like, is it someone you're familiar with?

Speaker

Yeah, yeah. Basically, someone who I've at least saw in my previous classes. So basically, they are the ones that I already know, even though I don't know their names or whatever they do.

Interviewer

Do you ever think about approaching someone that you did not know well, but you know about how they are performing in class or...?

Speaker

Actually, sometimes I do think about that, but since I don't really know much about my classmates, so sometimes I just have to gamble on it. So, like, pick someone and then think that this person might have a good, you know, a good way to handle a team.

Interviewer

What do you think so far about the groups that you have ever teamed up with?

Speaker

So far, I've got some people who are very nice, most of the teams. So this semester I'm doing like two teams, right?

One of the teams is actually very engaged, so we can actually talk about our project very well and we can do our topics. But at the same time, we also can talk about our personal thing. So it's kind of like very engaging.

But the other team is actually quiet. I don't know how to say it, but it's more like, it's kind of hard to pick something unless we vote for it.

So, in this other team, the dynamics is more like someone likes to talk a lot. So the only way we can actually choose our mechanism is to vote within all the ideas that we have already discussed.

Interviewer

Okay, okay. So what do you think is, like, the standard for a good team and a bad team?

Speaker

Okay, so I'll go first with a bad team. For me, it's a bad team if you cannot talk as a team.

What I mean by that is that sometimes you want to talk, the other person doesn't really want to listen, or the other way around. So it's just basically like communication.

But on the other hand, a good team is a team where everyone can speak and still understands—understanding each other, can have empathy towards the other team members, something like that.

Interviewer

Has there been someone you actively steered away from teaming up with?

Speaker

What do you mean?

Interviewer

Like, you avoid avoiding...?

Speaker

Um, not like particularly one person, but there are some people in the classroom, in the class situation, that I feel like they talk a lot, not really listening to people. So I kind of avoid that kind of people.

Interviewer

Now tell me about that time you didn't get to choose.

Speaker

Ah, so yeah, that's actually the one that I experienced with the first team in my course.

So that's the one when I asked the first team and they said that they need to think about it later, and then on the second week I come, all the team has already completed.

So, what I did back then was actually just come to a team and then ask them if they need someone else.

And fortunately, that team was actually quite open to allow me to be in their team, although they don't know yet if the tutor would allow them.

So what they did was that they came to the tutor and asked if it was okay to add another member.

Interviewer

If you were a tutor and had to split the whole class into groups yourself, how would you do it?

Speaker

Uh, I would make sure that the team has various backgrounds.

So if I'm a tutor, then I probably will have access to know what kind of course they are doing, what major they're doing. So I would probably try to make a team that has a lot of backgrounds so that they can actually talk a lot.

Interviewer

Do you have any particular method or tools, like how to form a team?

Speaker

I don't understand that question.

Interviewer

Do you know any kind of tools or method?

Speaker

Ah, how to form a team?

So, um, I don't know if it would fit something in the classroom here, but something that they usually do back in my home country is that they would ask each of the persons who are going to form a team to count with numbers.

So if we need a team—if we need like five teams, then we will have to count one to five. So it's more like randomized.

Interviewer

Yeah, randomized. Okay. Is there anything—last question—is there anything about forming teams for class projects that's not a surprise to you or that you just haven't thought about before?

Speaker

Um, I don't know. I think it's always funny that when we form a team.

Like, sometimes you're in a class and you don't know anyone in that classroom. Even if you know them, you still don't really get to know that person in person, right?

So it's always kind of exciting, but at the same time, it's always scary to form a team with those people.

So yeah, that's, I think that's, yeah, it's more like mixed feelings.

Interviewer

Yeah. Okay. Yeah, I think, okay, that's all. Thank you for your time.

Speaker

Thank you.